

FX Technical Update

Multiple dollar pairs faded near key levels and kept the market from confirming a more lasting trend reversal; the setup still keeps further dollar weakness as a favored outcome

- EUR/USD pulls back into 1.0315-1.0356 tactical support after the initial rebound from 1.02 faded shy of medium-term resistance near 1.06. The ability to hold the nearby levels will increase our conviction that the market is setting a more lasting bottom and a test of the 1.06 area in the weeks ahead.
- The cable rebound faded in the 1.2486-1.2575 cluster of resistance levels. Nearby support rests at 1.2349 and then 1.2292-1.2307. While the market can see further consolidation on the heels of the Sep-Jan trend, we'd expect residual strength to fade in that resistance zone again.
- The USD/JPY mean reversion from the 158.88 Jan high extended through the 50-day moving average and made its way closer to our favored targets at 152.555-153.03. Look for the pair to hold that area and trade into a range.
- The initial AUD/USD bounce from the potential base pattern that has formed near the 0.617 Oct 2022 low rejected the 0.6303 50-day moving average and other critical chart levels just overhead. In our view, that 0.6349-0.639 marks something of a bifurcation zone for the pair and potentially a signal level for the broader sentiment around the . In our view above, a sustained break above that area should be respected as a more lasting pro-cyclical signal across markets.
- USD/MXN fails to break below Oct-Jan trend line support that has defined a potential downside reversal pattern. Bearish signals have triggered on the daily and weekly time frames. A downside break below that trend line and the 20.021 pivot would allow for a slide to 19.066-19.15 support, in our view. Overhead resistance remains at 20.88-21.019.

Technical Strategy

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Real-time Technical
Commentary

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Figure 1: The dollar rebounds to test tactical resistance after last week's pattern breakdown. An inability to sustain a break back through the trend line that defined that Dec-Jan pattern would start to build confidence that a more lasting trend reversal is developing.

J.P. Morgan USD Currency Index (JPMQUSD Index), daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan. Bloomberg Finance L.P.

EUR/USD pulls back after the initial bounce from 1.02 faded shy of key resistance near 1.06

The **EUR/USD** pullback from the 1.0532 Dec 78.6% retrace nears what we've highlighted as tactical support at 1.0315-1.0356 (Figure 2). In our view, the ability for the pair to hold that cluster of levels will increase our confidence that the Jan bounce from the 1.02 Sep 2022 61.8% retrace marked a more lasting trend reversal rather than just another mean reversion in the continued impulse to lower prices that started at the 1.1216 Sep peak. Continued price action above nearby support would allow for a test of key resistance levels surrounding 1.06 that include the Sep 38.2% retrace, Dec high, and Apr 2024 range low. Note that the 100-day moving average is trending into that zone now, and the 200-day moving average is tracking lower toward that area as well. We suspect that cluster of resistance will mark a real sticking point for a rally through the first quarter and potentially first half of the year. On the downside, a renewed acceleration to lower prices through 1.02 would turn our attention to the 1.008 4Q22 pattern breakout and then 0.99% Sep 2022 78.6% retrace as longer-term support levels.

Figure 2: EUR/USD pulls back into 1.0315-1.0356 tactical support after the initial rebound from 1.02 faded shy of medium-term resistance near 1.06. The ability to hold the nearby levels will increase our conviction that the market set setting a more lasting bottom and a test of the 1.06 area in the weeks ahead.

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



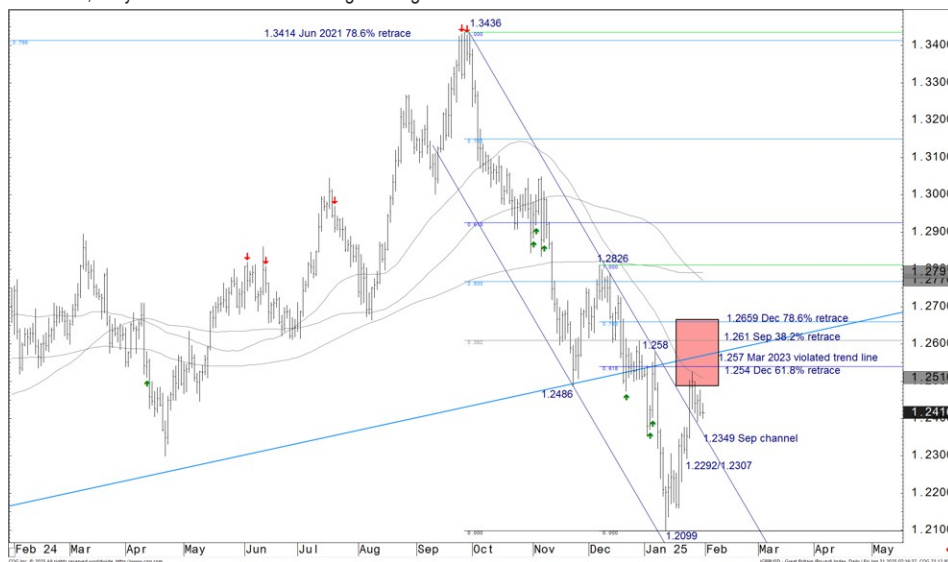
Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

The GBP/USD rebound faded at 1.2486-1.2575 resistance; look for that to continue to cap the pair

The **cable** rebound from the 1.2099 Jan 13 low faded near the 1.2486 Nov low, 1.2510 50-day MA, 1.254 Dec 61.8% retrace, and 1.257 Mar 2023 violated trend line (Figure 3). That marks the lower end of a broad confluence of resistance levels we think will cap the pair through the first quarter. Look for any residual strength to fade in that zone, or at the highest, near the 1.261 Sep 38.2% retrace and 1.2659 Dec 78.6% retrace. On the downside, nearby support rests at the 1.2349 Sep channel, which the market broke from last week. That is followed by 1.2292-1.2307 hourly chart pivots. We suspect the pair can consolidate below key resistance and above that short-term support over the near-term. Longer-term, the recent bounce developed without a clear reversal pattern developing on the chart, whereas those patterns are clear on other USD pair charts. Furthermore, a clear bullish reversal is also clear on the EUR/GBP chart from longer-term range support. Given those dynamics and the substantial breakdown pattern resistance just overhead, we suspect the pair will eventually come under renewed bearish pressure. The early-Jan price action overshot support in the 1.22-handles, but turned shy of the next major zone in the 1.18-handles. Given the large confluence of levels there, we suspect that will keep a floor under the pair in the first half of the year.

Figure 3: The cable rebound faded in the 1.2486-1.2575 cluster of resistance levels. Nearby support rests at 1.2349 and then 1.2292-1.2307. While the market can see further consolidation on the heels of the Sep-Jan trend, we'd expect residual strength to fade in that resistance zone again.

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

USD/JPY mean reversion approaches expected support at 152.555-153.03

USD/JPY maintains a downside near-term bias after the recent trend reversal pattern breakdown and break through the 50-day moving average (Figure 4). The pair is approaching our favored target zone set after the Dec-Jan bearish reversal pattern and momentum divergence signals fired into Jan. That includes the 153.03 Dec-Jan pattern objective, 152.844 200-day moving average, and 152.555 Nov 61.8% retrace. We suspect that zone will define the lower-end of a trading range that will contain the pair into March. On the upside, tactical resistance rests at the 153.023-156.755 recent pattern breakdown and late-Jan rebound highs. The Sep-Jan rally faded shy of the 159.256 Sep-Dec .618 swing objective.

Figure 4: The USD/JPY mean reversion from the 158.88 Jan high extended through the 50-day moving average and made its way closer to our favored targets at 152.555-153.03. Look for the pair to hold that area and trade into a range.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

AUD/USD bounce sees an initial fade from the 0.6349-0.639 key resistance zone

The AUD/USD rebound from a potential base pattern developing near the 0.617 Oct 2022 low faded at the 0.6303 50-day moving average and below critical medium-term resistance at the 0.6349 Aug 2024 range low and 0.639 2022-2024 internal trend line (Figure 5). We've viewed that confluence as a bifurcation zone for the pair and potential signal for cyclical markets more broadly. For now, the pair is left within its base pattern and presented with no shortage of headline risk regarding US trade policy. From a pure chart perspective, the momentum divergences that signaled as the pair decelerated near the 0.617 Oct 2022 low still imply a potential bullish reversal pattern. Even if the market extends lower, we see a material cluster of support at 0.6025-0.605 that we think can keep a floor under the pair through the quarter. Alternatively, an upside break through 0.635 has the potential to signal the start of a much more significant retracement of the Sep-Jan slide from the 0.6943 peak. Similar dynamics are present across a broad array of cyclically sensitive markets that we track and have maintained a loose correlation with the global manufacturing data. Across most of those markets, current price levels imply a near 50 global manufacturing PMI reading and show no excitement for a rebound in that stagnant multi-quarter data.

Figure 5: The initial AUD/USD bounce from the potential base pattern that has formed near the 0.617 Oct 2022 low rejected the 0.6303 50-day moving average and other critical chart levels just overhead. In our view, that 0.6349-0.639 marks something of a bifurcation zone for the pair and potentially a signal level for the broader sentiment around the . In our view above, a sustained break above that area should be respected as a more lasting pro-cyclical signal across markets.

AUD/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

USD/MXN stays in potential downside reversal pattern that has formed near 20.88-21.019 resistance

USD/MXN enters a weekend filled with headline risk still within a potential downside reversal pattern that has formed below the 20.88 Apr 2023-Jul 2024 pattern objective and 21.019 Apr 2020 50% retrace (Figure 6). Momentum divergences across the daily and weekly time-frames imply a maturing trend and an increased probability for mean reversion to lower levels. In our view, a break through the 20.275 trend line and 20.021 Dec 20 low would confirm that reversal and set the market on course for a test of the 19.15 Apr 2024 38.2% retrace and 19.066 Sep 2024 low. Other key support rests at 18.0465-18.4908, a likely floor for the months ahead. Alternatively, a re-acceleration to the upside and breakout would turn our attention to the next cluster of longer-term resistance at the 22.1455-22.1557 Jan 2022 high and Apr 2020 61.8% retrace.

Figure 6: USD/MXN fails to break below Oct-Jan trend line support that has defined a potential downside reversal pattern. Bearish signals have triggered on the daily and weekly time frames. A downside break below that trend line and the 20.021 pivot would allow for a slide to 19.066-19.15 support, in our view. Overhead resistance remains at 20.88-21.019.

USD/MXN, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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